



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 23

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Ventilation Requirements for Interior Finish Products

OVERVIEW:

The adhesives, caulks, stains, lacquers, and solvents used in interior finish work all contain volatile organic compounds that evaporate into the air during and after application. In a properly ventilated space, these vapors disperse quickly. In a closed, newly constructed interior without active HVAC, they

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Before applying any finish product in an interior space, verify that you have adequate ventilation. Adequate means that fresh air is moving through the space at a rate that dilutes solvent vapors below hazardous concentrations. Open windows and doors on opposite sides of the space to create cross-ventilation, and use a mechanical fan if natural ventilation is insufficient. The goal is to
2. Read the Safety Data Sheet before using any product you have not used before, or any product whose SDS you have not reviewed recently. Section 2 of the SDS identifies all chemical hazards. Section 7 gives ventilation requirements. Section 8 identifies required PPE including respirator type and cartridge selection. The SDS is not paperwork — it is the instruction manual for using that
3. Symptoms of acute solvent vapor overexposure include dizziness, lightheadedness, headache, nausea, and difficulty concentrating. These symptoms tell you that the ventilation is inadequate or your respiratory protection is insufficient. If any worker reports these symptoms, stop work, move everyone to fresh air, and increase ventilation before resuming. Do not push through it — these
4. Solvent-soaked rags are a spontaneous combustion hazard. This is not a theoretical risk — it causes real fires. Linseed oil, tung oil, and many finish products generate heat as they oxidize and cure. A pile of rags in a corner can reach ignition temperature in as little as a few hours. Always hang rags individually to dry in a ventilated area, or place them in a metal container with a

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Where are the Safety Data Sheets for the finish products we are using on this project right now?
Q2: What is the ventilation plan for finish work in this building before the HVAC system is operational?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Read the Safety Data Sheet (SDS) before using any new product
- Open windows and use fans to maintain fresh air during all application
- Exit the space immediately if you feel dizziness, nausea, or headache
- Store all solvent-based products away from all ignition sources
- Dispose of solvent-soaked rags in an approved metal container with a lid

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 23

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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